



Outsourcing Tasks

Finding professionals to help with specific operational tasks costs money, but can save you time and may increase your chances of commercial success.

Identifying your needs

Getting your business up and running can seem overwhelming, with many aspects to coordinate, such as dealing with customers, handling your accounts, and other legal requirements, plus providing your goods or services. However, this can be made simpler by looking at each function and deciding whether making use of external help is a good option.

Utilizing friends and family with specific skills is one possibility, while another is to seek out small business services that may be

available from government or civic organizations. You could also consider paying a professional for their services. This could be a one-off commission, such as a web designer creating a website, or it may be an ongoing arrangement, such as using a logistics company to store and ship your products.

These decisions will depend on the type of business you are setting up: a home-based, graphic design studio might need outside help only for end-of-year accounting, whereas a restaurateur may need a wider range of services.



NEED TO KNOW

- › **Inventory** describes the goods produced, or in production, that will be sold by a business.
- › **Logistics** manages how things are moved between the point of production to the consumer, including packaging, distribution, and transportation.
- › **SLA** (service level agreement) is a contract that lists the type and value of outsourced services, along with any conditions, such as annual maintenance.
- › **Warehousing** is the storage and management of goods waiting to be sent out to distributors and consumers.

Using third parties

Although keeping outgoings to a minimum is crucial for any new business, paying for outsourced services from a specialist can save money in the long run. There are a wide variety of services you may need. An independent professional can provide a fresh perspective, pointing out problems or suggesting solutions. However, before enlisting external services, it is important to be clear about the specific needs of your business and have an idea of budget. Ask for quotes before making a decision and research the outsourcers thoroughly. If there are no reviews online, ask for examples of their work and references from previous clients, and never pay for anything upfront.



Marketing

If your business needs specialist marketing expertise, a particular form of marketing, such as social media, or you want to launch a bigger campaign than you can handle in-house, you will need to go to professional marketers.

- › Creating content
- › Managing social media
- › Running email marketing



Website design and maintenance

Regular website maintenance is crucial for an e-commerce business and can be outsourced to an IT specialist, who may also offer website design. Occasional maintenance will suffice for less website-dependent businesses.

- › Managing updates
- › Hosting website
- › Search engine optimization



IT

For occasional or longer term IT needs, freelance or agency experts can improve computer networks and operating systems, as well as maximize the performance of your website.

- › Developing apps
- › Implementing new technology
- › Troubleshooting